SELECTED WORK | SANITIZED PROFESSIONAL EXAMPLES

Technical Documentation Portfolio

Declan T. Goodwin | Technical Writer and Information Architect

Selected DoD documentation, workflow, testing, and information-architecture case studies. The examples show how I investigate unfamiliar systems, reconcile stakeholder input, document real behavior, and create guidance that people can use, review, and maintain.

Controlled deliverables

CDRL intake, identifier control, attachments, status visibility, traceability, and administrator recovery.

Procedural documentation

Role-specific SOPs with ownership, prerequisites, dependencies, branching paths, and completion evidence.

Testing and assessment

Formal test plans, expected behavior, defects, usability findings, and actionable reporting.

Information governance

Taxonomy, naming conventions, permissions, lifecycle practices, revision controls, and repository standards.

Technical investigation

Systems configured, tested, troubleshot, and documented through direct use and SME collaboration.

Automation and AI

Power Platform workflows, GitHub publishing, LLM-assisted knowledge systems, and structured retrieval.

PORTFOLIO MAP

Sample	Primary evidence	Relevant deliverables
01 | CDRL workflow	Complete submission and tracking lifecycle	Implementation guidance, end-user instructions, traceability
02 | SOP suite	Six guides and 230+ role-specific actions	SOPs, process documentation, review-ready structure
03 | Information architecture	60+ page governance SOP and visual derivatives	Standards, templates, diagrams, content governance
04 | Visitor access workflow	Conditional guidance, status messaging, and exceptions	User guidance, notifications, administrator instructions
05 | Testing and investigation	Test plans, defects, ServiceNow evaluation	Test procedures, assessment reporting, adoption guidance
06 | Public documentation	GitHub Pages LangChain learning site	Conceptual writing, revision history, LLM familiarity

SANITIZATION

All examples are sanitized or reconstructed from unclassified material. Names, identifiers, internal paths, access details, operational information, and controlled content have been removed. Representative excerpts preserve the documentation structure and decision-making without exposing organizational information.

SAMPLE 01

CDRL Submission and Tracking Workflow

A controlled intake and tracking system built around the complete deliverable lifecycle, not merely a form submission.

PROBLEM	A manual intake process made identifier control, metadata quality, attachment handling, status visibility, and error recovery difficult to manage consistently.
MY ROLE	Mapped the lifecycle, designed the intake model, built the automation, tested the complete workflow, wrote user and administrator guidance, and documented recovery paths.
AUDIENCE	Personnel submitting contract deliverables and administrators maintaining the centralized tracking register.
PLATFORMS	Microsoft Forms, SharePoint Lists, Teams, Power Automate, automated email notifications, and structured attachments.

Lifecycle model

Stage	System behavior	Documentation need
1. Submit	Guided intake captures required metadata and files.	Field labels, examples, prerequisites, submission expectations
2. Validate	Required values and attachments are checked.	Validation messages and correction guidance
3. Record	The system assigns the next report identifier and creates the official record.	Identifier confirmation and traceability rules
4. Process	Attachments and metadata are associated with the centralized register.	Administrator verification and exception handling
5. Notify	Users and administrators receive state-specific messages.	Confirmations, status descriptions, next actions, recovery steps

Documentation decisions

Trace the transaction

Every message identifies the submission and current state so users and administrators can locate the correct record.

Write for the next action

User-facing content explains what happened and whether the reader must correct, wait, verify, or resubmit.

Design for recovery

Administrator alerts identify the failure point and provide concrete instructions for restoring the workflow.

Result

The workflow replaced an informal handoff with a guided submission interface, a centralized register embedded in the team workspace, sequential report-number control, organized attachments, meaningful status visibility, and actionable failure notifications.

SAMPLE 01 | ADAPTED EXCERPT

Representative CDRL Guidance

Sanitized reconstructions of the short, action-oriented messages used at meaningful state changes.

Event	Audience	Representative guidance
Submission accepted	Submitting user	Your deliverable was received and recorded as [Report ID]. The submission includes [file count] attachment(s). If corrections are required, the administrator will contact you.
Record created	Administrator	A new record was added to the tracking register. Review the assigned identifier, metadata, and attachment status before continuing processing.
Processing exception	Administrator	The system received submission [ID] but could not complete [processing step]. Follow the recovery steps below, then confirm the record is complete.
Missing information	Submitting user	Your submission could not be completed because a required field or attachment is missing. Return to the intake form, provide the listed item, and resubmit.
Administrative review	Administrator	Verify the report number, submitter, deliverable type, due date, attachment count, and processing status. Record any correction before final acceptance.

Administrator recovery pattern

Step	Instruction	Completion evidence
1. Identify	Open the failed run and confirm the last completed action.	Failure point recorded
2. Inspect	Compare the form response, list record, identifier, and attachment state.	Mismatch or missing item identified
3. Correct	Repair the affected record or attachment, then rerun only the required action.	Record and files reconciled
4. Verify	Confirm the centralized register and user-facing status reflect the corrected state.	Successful transaction confirmed
5. Close	Notify the submitter only when the record is complete or further action is required.	Final message sent

Why this matters

The value is not the automation alone. The workflow combines system behavior and documentation into one controlled experience: the interface sets expectations, notifications preserve visibility, administrator guidance supports recovery, and the tracking register maintains the record needed to manage the deliverable lifecycle.

SAMPLE 02

Role-Based Onboarding and Offboarding SOP Suite

Six coordinated guides that give civilian, contractor, and military personnel the shortest accurate path through a complex process.

PROBLEM	Three personnel categories followed overlapping but nonidentical check-in and check-out paths, with responsibilities distributed across many offices and additional branches for civilian and military entry conditions.
MY ROLE	Mapped the end-to-end process, separated user pathways, assigned ownership, documented prerequisites and dependencies, identified parallel work, and authored the complete suite.
DELIVERABLE	Six SOPs containing more than 230 documented actions. The suite was selected for adoption across an entire Headquarters Marine Corps division.

Representative procedure model

Step	Owner	Action	Dependency or evidence
1.1 Initiate	Operations lead	Provide effective date, personnel category, work location, and known access requirements.	Approved action or confirmed date
1.2 Route	Process coordinator	Verify existing enterprise identities and profiles. Select the abbreviated or full pathway.	Identity and account status
1.3 Issue	Process coordinator	Send the correct checklist, forms, training instructions, due dates, and submission method.	Correct guide selected
1.4 Coordinate	Process owners	Begin eligible access, equipment, badging, repository, and security actions in parallel.	Owner acknowledgement and status
1.5 Verify	IS and KM	Confirm accounts, records, permissions, and collaboration spaces. Record unresolved exceptions.	Completion evidence or exception

Pathway logic

Existing identity

Use the abbreviated route after verifying active accounts and training, then update local access and records.

New or inactive identity

Complete enterprise prerequisites before local setup and clearly identify which downstream actions must wait.

Blocked request

Record the blocker, assign an owner, preserve completed work, and resume when the required evidence becomes available.

Design principle

A universal SOP would have forced readers to interpret irrelevant conditions. Splitting the documentation by personnel category and process direction reduced ambiguity while preserving shared structure, terminology, ownership, and completion evidence.

SAMPLE 03

Information Architecture and Governance

A 60-plus-page operating guide that established how information should be organized, named, stored, reviewed, and maintained across multiple environments.

PROBLEM	Content was spread across classified and unclassified environments with inconsistent structures, naming, navigation, permissions, and lifecycle practices.
MY ROLE	Designed the information architecture, authored the governing SOP, created diagrams and quick-reference derivatives, and revised the structure through branch-level stakeholder reviews.
AUDIENCE	Operational users, repository owners, information managers, developers, and leadership working across Microsoft 365 and legacy environments.

Governance model

Layer	Purpose	Examples of guidance
Enterprise structure	Create predictable top-level navigation across environments.	Repository boundaries, ownership, cross-enclave pointers
Functional taxonomy	Organize information around enduring work rather than individual preference.	Branch spaces, capability areas, shared functions
Content patterns	Make recurring information easier to identify and retrieve.	Folder purposes, file types, templates, metadata
Lifecycle controls	Keep content current, reviewable, and appropriately retained.	Naming, versioning, review cadence, archival rules
Access and stewardship	Make responsibility and permissions visible.	Owners, contributors, readers, approval and escalation paths

Validation and derivative content

Stakeholder navigation

Branch representatives used the proposed structure to locate where current-state content should live and identify unclear labels or missing pathways.

Documentation refinement

Feedback was translated into structural revisions, clearer folder purposes, consistent terminology, and more explicit ownership.

Progressive disclosure

Dense governance material was converted into diagrams, one-page graphics, and quick-reference guidance for high-frequency tasks.

Result

The work created a shared operating model for repository structure and content stewardship, supported implementation decisions across three environments, and reduced the amount of organizational knowledge that depended on individual memory.

SAMPLE 04

Visitor Access Request Workflow

An end-to-end request process that pairs automation with conditional user guidance, meaningful status messaging, and administrator follow-up.

PROBLEM	Visitor requests required accurate routing, security-aware instructions, status visibility, and reliable follow-up across multiple personnel categories and classification conditions.
MY ROLE	Mapped the process, built the workflow, wrote and tested interface labels and messages, created dynamic reminder logic, documented administrator actions, and validated exception paths.
PLATFORMS	Microsoft Forms, SharePoint Lists, Power Automate, automated email, and team-managed records.

Conditional content model

Condition	Content changes	Documentation purpose
Personnel category	Contractor, civilian, and military pathways receive role-specific instructions.	Remove irrelevant actions and clarify responsibility
Security classification	Routine and SCI-related requests trigger different processing guidance.	Route work to the correct handling procedure
Workflow state	Received, under review, awaiting action, completed, and exception states use distinct messages.	Tell readers what happened and what comes next
Scheduled follow-up	Reminder timing adjusts to the request's current age and status.	Prevent stalled requests without creating daily noise
Processing failure	Administrators receive the affected step and recovery instructions.	Support correction without restarting valid work

Representative confirmation

> Your visitor access request was received and recorded as [Request ID]. Current status: [Status]. No further action is required unless Security contacts you. You will receive another message when the request advances or additional information is needed.

Content principle

A notification is useful only when it reduces uncertainty. Each message identifies the request, names the current state, explains what changed, and tells the reader whether action is required. The workflow documentation follows the same rule.

SAMPLE 05

Testing and Technical Investigation

Documentation grounded in direct system use, observed behavior, structured testing, and conversations with the people who build and operate the system.

Enterprise application testing

Activity	What was documented	Who used it
Functional testing	Inputs, actions, expected results, observed results, and completion status.	Developers and program stakeholders
Usability testing	Navigation problems, unclear labels, unnecessary effort, and points of user confusion.	Product owners and implementation teams
Regression testing	Previously working functions retested after changes, with new defects and side effects recorded.	Developers and testers
Defect reporting	Reproduction steps, failure conditions, affected workflow, evidence, and recommended priority.	Technical teams and leadership
Assessment reporting	Findings translated into concise decisions, risks, mitigations, and next actions.	Program and executive stakeholders

ServiceNow investigation

CONSTRAINT	A heavily customized Navy ServiceNow environment did not align cleanly with the expected operating model and was not sufficiently documented for the intended use case.
INVESTIGATION	Completed a 72-hour evaluation, interviewed developers and operational stakeholders, configured 20 to 30 Epics and Initiatives plus thousands of work items, and compared observed behavior with expected process.
OUTPUTS	Leadership briefing, structured findings, clarified system boundaries, and an end-user SOP supporting Project Dynamis adoption.

Documentation method

Observe

Use the system, reproduce the workflow, and identify the actual decision points and failure conditions.

Reconcile

Compare technical behavior, stakeholder explanations, governing requirements, and user expectations.

Explain

Create guidance that distinguishes expected behavior, limitations, exceptions, and the actions users can take.

What this demonstrates

The writing is not assembled from secondhand notes. It comes from the same cycle used to solve the underlying problem: investigate, configure, test, compare, clarify, document, and revise.

SAMPLE 06

Public Documentation and Emerging Tools

A public GitHub Pages learning project and an internal AI knowledge-system proof of concept demonstrate continued growth into modern software and LLM documentation.

LangChain learning documentation

The public site explains LangChain for readers moving from general AI familiarity toward more technical product and architecture decisions. It uses beginner, intermediate, and advanced layers; expandable sections; diagrams; repeated content patterns; consistent terminology; explicit product boundaries; and guidance on when a simpler approach may be better.

Level	Purpose	Representative content
Beginner	Build the mental model	What LangChain is, what problem it solves, who uses it, and when it may be unnecessary
Intermediate	Explain the system	Models, messages, tools, agents, state, memory, middleware, structured output, and product relationships
Advanced	Expose design choices	Execution control, persistence, failure handling, evaluation, deployment, and implementation tradeoffs

AI knowledge-system proof of concept

After completing Palantir Maven Smart System and Foundry training, I developed a proof-of-concept capability that transformed organizational documentation into structured content chunks for conversational search and retrieval. The work connected information architecture, chunking decisions, source organization, and user retrieval needs.

GitHub publishing

HTML, CSS, Markdown, static-site publishing, commits, and visible revision history.

LLM documentation

Terminology, product boundaries, state and memory concepts, failure modes, and architecture decisions.

Editorial judgment

Explain concepts before procedures, preserve technical distinctions, and state when not to use a tool.

PUBLIC LINKS

LangChain documentation: declan-goodwin.github.io/-Dgoodwin-Learning-Chain-Gang/whats-langchain

GitHub portfolio: github.com/Declan-Goodwin/technical-writing-portfolio

CONTACT

Declan T. Goodwin | Fredericksburg, Virginia | Declan.goodwin1252@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/declan-goodwin

These examples are representative, sanitized, and intended to demonstrate documentation structure, reasoning, and communication decisions. They do not reproduce controlled source material.